Quality Control Layer 1: Research & Factual Accuracy Audit

Lesson: HTTP Requests and Responses | **Audit Reference:** AUDIT-FACT-001

Overall Audit Status: NEEDS IMPROVEMENT **Factual Accuracy Score:** 94.0% **Issues Detected:** 4

1. Executive Accuracy Assessment

The lesson's technical content is largely accurate and consistent with RFC 9110 and MDN Web Docs. GET/POST semantics, status code classes, and example codes are correctly described. However, research integrity is weakened by citations to a book available only as metadata/preview (Source [3]) and a YouTube video (Source [4]) used to support factual claims, plus inconsistent attribution and one minor terminological simplification regarding 403 Forbidden.

2. Factual Claims Analysis & Corrections (4 items)

ID / Severity	Affected Section & Claim	Audit Finding & Supporting Evidence	Recommended Correction
FACT-001 MEDIUM	**Section:** Section 4 (API Debugging Practices), Section 6 (Real-World Applications), Section 9 (Summary) *"Claims supported by citation to [HTTP: The Definitive Guide] (Source [3])"*	Source [3] is listed as accessible only via Metadata/Preview. Full text is not available for verification, so claims attributed to this source cannot be confirmed against the actual book content. While the claims themselves are standard industry knowledge, the citation is unverifiable and misrepresents the strength of the supporting evidence. **Evidence:** Source metadata indicates "Accessible: Metadata/Preview only"	**Fix:** Replace citations to Source [3] with citations to RFC 9110 or MDN Web Docs, or remove the citation and present the information as general best practice without attributing it to the unverifiable book preview.
FACT-002 LOW	**Section:** Section 9 (Summary) *"You now have the foundation to read API traffic, distinguish client from server failures, and apply basic debugging practices [HTTP Crash Course & Status Codes Explained]."*	Source [4] is a YouTube video. While useful as a supplementary resource, it is not an authoritative technical specification and should not be cited as a factual reference for core lesson content. **Evidence:** Source [4] is a YouTube video; not an IETF RFC or formal technical documentation.	**Fix:** Remove the citation from the summary or relegate Source [4] to the Additional Resources section only, without using it to support factual claims.

FACT-003 LOW	**Section:** Section 4 (Status Code Categories - 4xx Client Error) *"`403 Forbidden`: Authenticated but not permitted."*	RFC 9110 Section 15.5.3 defines 403 Forbidden as indicating that the server understood the request but refuses to authorize it. It does not require that the client be successfully authenticated; the server may refuse authorization for any reason. Describing it strictly as "Authenticated but not permitted" is a common simplification but technically incomplete. **Evidence:** RFC 9110 Section 15.5.3	**Fix:** Change to "`403 Forbidden`: The server understood the request but refuses to authorize it."
FACT-004 LOW	**Section:** Section 3 (Key Concepts - Core Definitions) *"`POST`: Submits data to be processed by a resource (e.g., creating a new record). It is not idempotent and typically includes a request body."*	This definition lacks a citation to an authoritative source, unlike the GET definition which cites MDN. While factually correct, the absence of attribution creates inconsistency in source verification. **Evidence:** RFC 9110 Section 9.3.3; MDN Web Docs	**Fix:** Add citation to [RFC 9110: HTTP Semantics] or [MDN Web Docs: HTTP request methods & response status codes].

3. Verification Scope & Limitations

Source [3] (HTTP: The Definitive Guide) is accessible only as metadata/preview; specific page-level claims cannot be verified against full text. Source [4] is a YouTube video; video content cannot be fully verified as a stable textual technical source.

4. Conclusion & Certification

Factually sound technical content with minor citation and attribution issues requiring correction before publication.